Blights

Plants Sprouted from Evil

Habitat: Forest; **Treasure:** None

Blights are malicious plants that sprout from deep-rooted evil. Their gnarled forms twist with fearsome features suggestive of human limbs and vicious maws. Blights lurk in ambush amid mundane vegetation and lash out at non-Plant creatures. While blights can act independently, they're usually motivated by whatever sinister forces spawned them or by wicked creatures with control over nature. The magic that creates blights often affects other vegetation as well, causing brambles, vines, and gnarled trees to overwhelm roads and fields, choke wells and streams, and force animals from their natural habitat. This might make blights the first sign of an oncoming wave of corruption.

Twig Blight

Twig Blight

Resembling bundles of sticks or dead brush, twig blights easily blend in among deadwood, flotsam, and the wood piles common in many rural settings. Groups of them are often found near river crossings, forgotten wells, or natural campsites, where they ambush those who let down their guard.

Twig Blight

Small Plant, Neutral Evil

AC 14 **Initiative** +2 (12)
HP 7 (2d6)
Speed 20 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	6	−2	−2	**Dex**	14	+2	+2	**Con**	11	+0	+0
Int	4	−3	−3	**Wis**	8	−1	−1	**Cha**	3	−4	−4

Skills Stealth +4
Vulnerabilities Fire
Immunities Deafened
Senses Blindsight 60 ft.; Passive Perception 9
Languages Understands Common but can't speak
CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Pack Tactics. The blight has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the blight's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

Actions

Claw. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) Slashing damage.

BRIAN VALEZA

Needle Blight

Needle blights have vaguely bipedal forms, with gaunt, misshapen limbs. Whether standing unnaturally still or lurching with their awkward gaits, these blights can't pass as either normal plants or woodland travelers. Once they spot foes, needle blights attack using their thorn-covered claws or by rapidly growing and flinging volleys of serrated, needlelike projectiles.

Needle Blight

Medium Plant, Neutral Evil

AC 12 **Initiative** +1 (11)
HP 16 (3d8 + 3)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	12	+1	+1	**Dex**	12	+1	+1	**Con**	13	+1	+1
Int	4	−3	−3	**Wis**	8	−1	−1	**Cha**	3	−4	−4

Immunities Deafened
Senses Blindsight 60 ft.; Passive Perception 9
Languages Understands Common but can't speak
CR 1/4 (XP 50; PB +2)

Actions

Claw. *Melee Attack Roll:* +3, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (2d4 + 1) Slashing damage.

Needles. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +3, range 30/60 ft. *Hit:* 6 (2d4 + 1) Piercing damage.

Left to Right: Vine Blight, Tree Blight, and Needle Blight

Vine Blight

Medium Plant, Neutral Evil

AC 12 **Initiative** −1 (9)
HP 19 (3d8 + 6)
Speed 20 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	15	+2	+2	**Dex**	8	−1	−1	**Con**	14	+2	+2
Int	5	−3	−3	**Wis**	10	+0	+0	**Cha**	3	−4	−4

Skills Stealth +1
Immunities Deafened
Senses Blindsight 60 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages Common
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Actions

Constricting Vine. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) Bludgeoning damage. If the target is a Large or smaller creature, it has the Grappled condition (escape DC 12). Until the grapple ends, the target takes 4 (1d8) Bludgeoning damage at the start of each of its turns, and the blight can't make Constricting Vine attacks.

Entangling Plants (Recharge 5–6). The blight casts the *Entangle* spell, using Constitution as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12).

Tree Blight

Huge Plant, Neutral Evil

AC 15 **Initiative** +3 (13)
HP 115 (10d12 + 50)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	23	+6	+6	**Dex**	10	+0	+0	**Con**	20	+5	+5
Int	6	−2	−2	**Wis**	10	+0	+0	**Cha**	3	−4	−4

Immunities Deafened
Senses Blindsight 60 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages Understands Common and Druidic but can't speak
CR 7 (XP 2,900; PB +3)

Actions

Multiattack. The blight makes two Branch attacks and uses Grasping Root.

Branch. *Melee Attack Roll:* +9, reach 15 ft. *Hit:* 16 (3d6 + 6) Bludgeoning damage.

Grasping Root. *Strength Saving Throw:* DC 17, one Large or smaller creature the blight can see within 15 feet. *Failure:* The target is pulled up to 10 feet straight toward the blight and has the Grappled condition (escape DC 16) from one of six roots. Until the grapple ends, the target takes 13 (2d6 + 6) Bludgeoning damage at the start of each of its turns.

Bonus Actions

Gnash. *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 17, one creature Grappled by the blight. *Failure:* 19 (3d8 + 6) Piercing damage. *Success:* Half damage.

BRIAN VALEZA

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Vine Blight

Vine blights resemble humans wrapped in vines common to the areas in which they grow, from hairy ivy vines to flowering kudzu. They can cause plants to burst from the ground around themselves and entangle nearby foes.

Unlike most other blights, vine blights can speak. They do so rarely, typically only to convey messages from their masters or to repeat the words of their victims in rasping voices.

Tree Blight

Tree blights look like ancient, dead trees with gnarled limbs and splintered hollows. Imbued with bloodlust, these blights feed on the living. Evidence of their past meals is often tangled amid their branches and roots. Tree blights cooperate with other blights, but they attack other tree-shaped beings they encounter, such as awakened trees and treants.

Gulthias Blight

Ancient plants twisted by evil, Gulthias blights feed on blood and despoil the surrounding land, often giving rise to subservient blights. These cursed plants take their name from the story of their creation; the first of their kind was a tree that grew from the stake piercing the heart of the vampire Gulthias. These blights consider all creatures either servants or fertilizer for the blights' corruption.

> It lives, though it looks dead. In an age long past, someone staked a vampire to the earth on this very spot. The wooden stake was yet green and took root. And so grew the Gulthias Tree, reverberating with primal power.
>
> —Belak the Outcast, druid of the Twilight Grove

Gulthias Blight

Gargantuan Plant, Neutral Evil

AC 20 **Initiative** +5 (15)
HP 264 (16d20 + 96)
Speed 50 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
Str	25	+7	+7	**Dex**	10	+0	+0	**Con**	22	+6	+6
Int	10	+0	+0	**Wis**	18	+4	+4	**Cha**	12	+1	+1

Skills Perception +9
Resistances Fire, Necrotic
Immunities Deafened
Senses Blindsight 120 ft.; Passive Perception 19
Languages Common, Druidic
CR 16 (XP 15,000; PB +5)

Traits

Blight Seeds. When it finishes a Long Rest, the blight expels 1d6 seeds into unoccupied spaces on the ground within 30 feet of itself. After 24 hours, the seeds become creatures under the blight's control. Roll 1d8 for each seed to determine the creature it becomes: on 1–4, **Twig Blight**; on 5–6, **Needle Blight**; on 7–8, **Vine Blight**.

Actions

Multiattack. The blight makes two attacks, using Slam or Thorn Volley in any combination. It also uses Life-Draining Root.

Slam. *Melee Attack Roll:* +12, reach 10 ft. *Hit:* 25 (4d8 + 7) Bludgeoning damage.

Thorn Volley. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +12, range 60/180 ft. *Hit:* 20 (3d8 + 7) Piercing damage.

Life-Draining Root. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 20, one Huge or smaller creature the blight can see within 30 feet. *Failure:* 14 (2d6 + 7) Necrotic damage, and the target has the Grappled condition (escape DC 17) from one of six roots. Until the grapple ends, the target has the Restrained condition and takes 14 (4d6) Necrotic damage at the start of each of its turns. The target's Hit Point maximum decreases by an amount equal to the Necrotic damage taken, and the blight regains Hit Points equal to that amount.